When I was little: could / couldn't

Lesson 2-2
Book pages 41

💡 **Big idea:** We use **could** and **couldn't** to talk about abilities in the past: When I was one, I **could** walk but I **couldn't** talk.

🎯 **I will learn:**
- Name everyday action verbs
- Use could and couldn't for past ability
- Ask Could you...? and answer
- Talk about what I could do when I was little

📖 Key words

post a letter يرسل رسالة بالبريد	**send an email** يرسل بريدًا إلكترونيًا	**make a face** يعمل تعابير بوجهه	**tell a story** يحكي قصة
hold a pen يمسك قلمًا	**win a race** يفوز بسباق	**make a sandwich** يصنع شطيرة	**tie a shoelace** يربط رباط الحذاء

could / couldn't

- When I was one, I **could** walk but I **couldn't** talk.
- When I was two, I could hold a big pen.
- When I was four, I couldn't tie a shoelace.

Questions

- **Could** you talk when you were two?
- Yes, I **could**. / No, I **couldn't**.
- What could you do when you were five? What couldn't you do?

Remember

- could + verb (no -s, no -ed)
- couldn't = could not



✏️ Examples

When I was six, I ___ tell a story. (yes)

Answer: could

Could you tie a shoelace when you were four? (no)

Answer: No, I couldn't.

⭐ Remember

- could = استطعت (في الماضي) ، couldn't = لم أستطع

⚠️ Watch out

- Say 'I could swim', not 'I could swam' or 'I could to swim'.

🧩 **Activity:** Tell your partner three things you could do and three things you couldn't do when you were five

✅ Check yourself

1. Past of 'can'?
2. Negative of 'could'?
3. Arabic of 'tie a shoelace'?
4. Could you walk when you were one?

Answers: (1) could ، (2) couldn't ، (3) يربط رباط الحذاء ، (4) Yes, I could.